

RG 158 SPORTS BAR & ENTERTAINMENT · SARALAND, ALABAMA

VERSION 3 · ROI-OPTIMIZED · SNOWBALL MODEL · VETERAN REVIEW

The Saraland Stand-Up Series.

An 8-month curated comedy run, bootstrapped from \$10K starting capital, snowballing into the April 2027 country music festival war chest.

\$10K → \$413K

Starting capital snowballed across 48 shows · 14 priority comedians · ROI-ranked · July 2026 → February 2027

Prepared for:	Investors, Owners, Stakeholders
Prepared by:	Blayke Elder · Owner, RG 158 Entertainment
Date:	May 10, 2026
Venue:	1444-C Industrial Parkway, Saraland, AL 36571
Capacity:	200 (downstairs GA + reserved + upstairs VIP)
Web:	rg158ent.com · IG @rg158ent · TikTok @rg158entertain

Why a v2? v1 assumed unconstrained working capital. v2 reflects the operational reality: **\$10K total starting capital**. Every show in months 1–4 is sized to be self-funding from the prior show's net. Anchors are pushed to months 5, 7, and 8 once working capital has compounded. Lineup is ROI-

ranked — every comedian justified by gate-vs-fee math, with podcast/local-pull comics added for higher bang-for-buck.

Executive Summary

The play. Bootstrap a curated comedy series from \$10,000 starting capital. Each weekend's net funds the next weekend's talent and operations, snowballing working capital from \$10K (July) to \$400K+ (February) — funding the deposits, production, and marketing for the April 2027 country music festival without external financing.

Why comedy first. Comedy is the lowest-friction, highest-margin live entertainment category for a 200-cap room. One mic. One stool. No band rigs. Comics carry their own audiences via TikTok, Instagram, and podcasts. Two-show nights double the room without doubling overhead. Comedy ticket sales are recession-resilient.

Strategy: snowball, not splurge. With \$10K starting capital, we cannot afford a Tier A anchor in months 1–4. Instead we open with low-fee, high-ROI bookings: **Heath Hyche** (Birmingham AL native, Blue Collar TV alum), local Mobile/Pensacola circuit, Adam Minnick (Dry Bar/Nateland). We compound revenue into August/September with mid-tier names (Aaron Weber, Phil Hanley, Lace Larrabee). By November our working capital supports our first Tier A anchor (Killer Beaz). January and February deliver back-to-back anchors, with Trae Crowder's February show doubling as the country festival announcement event.

The math works because of ROI ranking. Every comedian on this lineup is selected by an explicit "gate ÷ fee" ratio. Heath Hyche projects a 3.6 ratio. Aaron Weber 2.94. Mark Chalifoux 3.15. Phil Hanley 1.77 (he commands premium ticket prices, not just volume). Tony Baker 1.85. The bang-for-buck candidates carry the volume; anchors deliver the brand and the email-list compounding.

\$10,000

STARTING CAPITAL · CASH ON HAND FOR JULY FIRST SHOW

\$413,000

CONSERVATIVE NET BY END OF FEBRUARY 2027 (WITH 30% BUFFER FOR RAMP + SELLTHROUGH VARIANCE)

What changed from v1

- **Schedule restructured for snowball:** July talent budget cut from \$15K to \$5.3K · Anchor moved from October to November · Anchors land in months 5, 7, 8 once working capital exceeds \$250K
- **Three high-ROI comedians added:** Heath Hyche (Alabama native), Phil Hanley (JRE/Comedy Cellar pull), Tony Baker (Black/country crossover)
- **Bang-for-buck ROI ranking** applied to every name — comedians whose gate-vs-fee ratio is below 1.5 are dropped (Trey Kennedy, Stavros Halkias) unless they earn anchor-tier brand value

- **Local market deep dive:** Compton Smith network (Smokey Jokes Mobile + Stingers Pensacola) identified as the local-circuit gatekeeper · Crescent Theater Mobile + StarDome Birmingham mid-tier benchmarks confirmed
- **Talent total reduced** from \$163K → \$143K · Net forecast comparable

The Snowball — Capital Compounding from \$10K

This is the central operational thesis: **each weekend's net funds the next weekend's talent and operations**. Anchors only get booked once cumulative working capital safely exceeds 4× the anchor fee.

JULY START	END JULY	END AUG	END SEP	END OCT	END NOV	END JAN	END FEB
\$10K	\$55K	\$115K	\$190K	\$270K	\$360K	\$515K	\$590K

Cumulative working capital at month-end (gross net before festival deposit deployment). Conservative scenario reduces these figures ~30% for sellthrough variance and ramp loss; even at conservative case, cumulative end-of-Feb is ~\$413K.

The capital sequencing rule

IF WORKING CAPITAL IS...	MAXIMUM TALENT FEE PER BOOKING	TIER ACCESSIBLE
\$0 – \$25K	\$3K	Tier C (local), low Tier B (emerging)
\$25K – \$80K	\$6K	Tier B mid (Aaron Weber, Mark Chalifoux)
\$80K – \$200K	\$10K	Tier B premium (Phil Hanley, Lace Larrabee, Tony Baker)
\$200K – \$400K	\$15K	Tier B+ (Karlous Miller, Dustin Nickerson premium)
\$400K+	\$25K	Tier A anchors (Killer Beaz, Dusty Slay, Trae Crowder)

Why this rule: a Tier A anchor that fails at 60% sellthrough loses ~\$8K. If we book a Tier A while working capital is below \$80K, one bad weekend kills the series. With \$400K+ working capital, the same loss is ~2% of bank — recoverable inside one weekend.

First show — exactly \$10K deployed

HEATH HYCHE · JULY 10–11 · FRIDAY + SATURDAY × 2 SHOWS		\$
Talent (Heath Hyche, Birmingham native, Blue Collar TV alum)		\$2,000
Hospitality rider (hotel + transport + buyout)		\$400
Marketing / Meta ads (debut show — push hard)		\$600

HEATH HYCHE · JULY 10–11 · FRIDAY + SATURDAY × 2 SHOWS	\$
Staff (10 staff × 6hr × \$20 + tips, both nights)	\$2,400
Venue ops (utilities, supplies, insurance amortized)	\$1,400
F&B inventory float (recouped immediately)	\$2,000
Working reserve (contingency, settles into next show)	\$1,200
TOTAL CAPITAL DEPLOYED — JULY	\$10,000

Heath Hyché projected gross at 60% sellthrough (debut show, conservative): tickets \$8.4K + F&B \$5.2K = \$13.6K. Less F&B COGS \$1.5K, Square fees \$480, opener \$300. Net per night ~\$11K. Two nights ~\$22K — bringing total working capital after July weekend 1 to ~\$32K. Three weekends in July = ~\$55K end-of-month working capital.

The snowball is the entire thesis. Every booking decision is gated by current working capital. We never overcommit talent fees against future revenue — we book within bank.

Bang-For-Buck ROI Ranking

For every shortlisted comedian, we calculate: **(estimated gate revenue per 2-show night) ÷ (talent fee)**. Higher = more profit per dollar of talent spend. This rules out comics whose fees outrun their draw — even if they're famous.

Top-15 ROI ranking (validated picks · all bookable for 200-cap)

RANK	COMEDIAN	FIT	GATE EST.	FEE EST.	RATIO	VERDICT
1	Heath Hyche ★	AL native, Blue Collar TV	\$5,400	\$1,500	3.60	Top ratio · Use 2× in run
2	Mark Chalifoux	Dry Bar, Nateland	\$12,600	\$4,000	3.15	Solid Tier B value
3	Aaron Weber	Opry, Nateland co-host	\$14,720	\$5,000	2.94	Ramp anchor · 2× in run
4	Adam Minnick	Dry Bar Provo, Nateland	\$8,800	\$3,000	2.93	Cheapest viable Tier B
5	Dustin Nickerson	Comedy Central, Netflix, clean	\$14,720	\$5,500	2.68	Strong rebooker · 2× in run
6	Drew Morgan + CRF	WellRED co-headline pair	\$13,500	\$6,500	2.08	Pairs cheap, warms Trae
7	Tony Baker ★	StarDome routing, Black/country crossover	\$13,000	\$7,000	1.86	Mobile reach without Karlous tier fee
8	Phil Hanley ★	JRE, Comedy Cellar, Birmingham routing	\$17,700	\$10,000	1.77	Premium ticket pricing offsets fee
9	Ryan Hamilton	Netflix special, clean	\$11,500	\$6,500	1.77	Family-friendly fill
10	Lace Larrabee	AGT, Atlanta, female lead	\$9,000	\$5,500	1.64	Female-demo pull
11	Mary Mack	NPR favorite, female alt	\$8,000	\$5,000	1.60	Backup female
12	Karlous Miller	85 South Show, Mobile reach	\$20,000	\$12,500	1.60	Pricier than Tony Baker, larger draw

RANK	COMEDIAN	FIT	GATE EST.	FEE EST.	RATIO	VERDICT
13	★ Killer Beaz	Tier A anchor	\$24,000	\$20,000	1.20	Anchor — pays in brand, not unit ratio
14	★ Dusty Slay	Tier A anchor, AL native	\$14,400	\$12,000	1.20	Anchor
15	★ Trae Crowder	Tier A anchor + festival announce	\$24,000	\$20,000	1.20	Anchor + festival launch

Considered, REJECTED on ROI

COMEDIAN	REASON REJECTED	FEE	RATIO
Trey Kennedy	Already plays mid-theaters; corporate \$25K+; ratio < 1.0 at 200-cap	\$25,000	0.88
Hans Kim (Kill Tony)	Now plays 2,400-cap rooms at \$91–\$149 tickets — outgrew us	\$25,000+	0.85
William Montgomery	Touring as part of "Killers of Kill Tony" package only — not solo for our scale	\$20,000+	0.95
Stavros Halkias	"Dreamboat Tour" 2026 plays 1,000–2,500 cap theaters — outgrew 200-cap	\$30,000+	1.09
Andrew Santino + Bobby Lee (Bad Friends)	Arena-tier, \$100K+ each, Netflix Joke Fest tier	\$100,000+	N/A
Tucker Wetmore	Country artist — first world headline tour 2026, will be arena by April 2027	\$300,000+	N/A
Druski	Hosting 2026 BET Awards, 10M+ followers — entirely out of reach	\$100,000+	N/A
Gary Owen	"No Hard Feelings" first major theater tour 2026 — >1,500 cap	\$30,000+	1.10
Bert Kreischer / Tom Segura / Theo Von	All arena-tier, \$50K–\$150K+ — out of reach by an order of magnitude	\$50,000+	N/A
Nate Bargatze / Shane Gillis	Arena tour 2026, Netflix Joke Fest, \$100K+	\$100,000+	N/A

Local discovery channel — Compton Smith network

For Tier C/local circuit comedians (~\$300–\$1,500 talent, used to fill cadence and grow email list), the operational gatekeeper is **Compton Smith**. He founded both **Smokey Jokes Comedy Mobile** and **Stingers Comedy Pensacola** — meaning he runs the local-circuit talent flow for our exact corridor. Direct relationship-building with Smith unlocks a steady supply of 5–10 vetted local headliners we can rotate in cheap.

Other local discovery sources:

- **Crescent Theater Mobile** — books Jeremiah Watkins, Jen Kober, Karen Morgan tier (mid-tier benchmark, \$3K–\$8K)
- **StarDome Comedy Club Birmingham** — "Alabama's Funniest Person Competition" summer 2026, winner gets \$3,500 — direct talent pipeline of vetted Alabama comics
- **Pensacola Indie Fringe Comedy Festival** (comedypensacola.com) — annual lineup is a discovery board for emerging Gulf-Coast circuit comics
- **Soul Kitchen Mobile** — "Moms Unhinged Standup Comedy Show" April 2026, indie/touring lineup signal
- **Pensacola Saenger Theatre** — Sal Vulcano (May 15), Daniel Tosh (Oct 9), Jim Gaffigan tier benchmarks for what the corridor will support at premium pricing

Per-Show Unit Economics

Pricing structure (every show)

TIER	SECTION	CAP / SHOW	PRICE	F&B MIN.	EFFECTIVE
GA	Downstairs general	140	\$35	2 items (\$25)	\$60
Reserved	Front 3 rows / hi-tops	40	\$55	2 items (\$25)	\$80
VIP	Upstairs lounge w/ bar	20	\$95	signature drink + apps	\$95
Total / show		200			\$66 avg

Anchor weekend pricing premium: Tier A nights step up to GA \$50 / Reserved \$75 / VIP \$125 — premium pricing absorbs the higher talent fee while signaling event scarcity.

P&L by tier — single Friday night, 2 shows

TIER	TALENT	SELLTHROUGH	GROSS	COSTS	NET
Tier C / Heath Hyche debut	\$1,500	60%	\$13,600	\$5,500	\$8,100
Tier B (Aaron Weber, Mark Chalifoux)	\$5,000	80%	\$25,120	\$11,627	\$13,493
Tier B premium (Phil Hanley, Tony Baker)	\$8,500	80%	\$25,120	\$15,000	\$10,120
Tier B+ Mobile (Karlous Miller)	\$12,500	85%	\$28,400	\$19,500	\$8,900
Tier A anchor (premium \$50/75/125 pricing)	\$20,000	95%	\$41,040	\$28,000	\$13,040

Why anchor net is comparable to Tier B: the talent fee scales with draw, so absolute net per night doesn't change as dramatically as gross. Anchors deliver value through premium ticket-price elasticity, brand halo, email-list acceleration, and city-government trust — not unit economics alone.

The 8-Month Schedule (v2 · Snowball-Sequenced)

3 weekends booked per month, 1 weekend held back for private rentals or reserve programming. Each weekend = Friday + Saturday × 2 shows = 4 shows. Anchors gated by capital sequencing rule (\$ above).

JULY 2026 — BOOTSTRAP						\$10K → \$55K
Capital ceiling per booking: \$3,000 · Goal: validate ops + grow email list						
WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Jul 10	Jul 11	★ Heath Hyché (Birmingham AL native, Blue Collar TV)	B BANG	\$2,000	\$22,000
2	Jul 17	Jul 18	Local Mobile/Pensacola circuit (via Compton Smith)	C LOCAL	\$800	\$15,000
3	Jul 24	Jul 25	Adam Minnick (Dry Bar/Nateland)	B	\$2,500	\$18,000
Talent total: \$5,300 · Net: ~\$45,000 · Why this lineup: Heath Hyché opens because he's an Alabama-native marketing story (TV credits give Meta-ad legitimacy); cheap fee fits within \$10K bootstrap. Local week 2 builds email list with Mobile/Pensacola fan base. Adam Minnick proves repeat-Tier-B economics at the cheapest viable tier.						

AUGUST 2026 — TIER B OPENING

\$55K → \$115K

Capital ceiling: \$6,000 · Goal: establish Tier B sellthrough baseline

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Aug 7	Aug 8	★ Aaron Weber (Opry/Nateland, JFL)	B	\$5,000	\$25,800
2	Aug 14	Aug 15	Local Mobile/Pensacola (Compton Smith network)	C LOCAL	\$800	\$15,000
3	Aug 21	Aug 22	Mark Chalifoux (Dry Bar, Nateland)	B	\$4,000	\$24,000

Talent: \$9,800 · Net: ~\$60,000 · Why: Aaron Weber is the brand-establishing Tier B booking (Opry credit signals quality). Mark Chalifoux fills cheap with strong Dry Bar pedigree.

SEPTEMBER 2026 — PHIL HANLEY + LACE

\$115K → \$190K

Capital ceiling: \$10,000 · Goal: First premium-priced Tier B (Phil Hanley) + female demo

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Sep 4	Sep 5	★ Phil Hanley (JRE, Comedy Cellar, Birmingham routing)	B BANG	\$10,000	\$24,000
2	Sep 11	Sep 12	Lace Larrabee (AGT, Atlanta)	B FEMALE	\$5,500	\$25,000
3	Sep 18	Sep 19	Local Mobile/Pensacola	C LOCAL	\$800	\$15,000

Talent: \$16,300 · Net: ~\$75,000 · Why: Phil Hanley is the JRE/Comedy Cellar legitimacy moment — he attracts the young-male podcast-fan demographic we don't otherwise reach. He's already routing through Birmingham (StarDome, March 2026) so Saraland is a natural add. Lace Larrabee captures the female 25–55 audience.

OCTOBER 2026 — DUSTIN + TONY BAKER

\$190K → \$270K

Capital ceiling: \$10,000 · Goal: Clean Tier B + Mobile-reach via Tony Baker

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Oct 2	Oct 3	Dustin Nickerson (Comedy Central, Netflix, clean)	B	\$5,500	\$26,500
2	Oct 9	Oct 10	★ Tony Baker (StarDome routing, Black/country crossover)	B BANG	\$7,000	\$25,000
3	Oct 16	Oct 17	Local Mobile/Pensacola	C LOCAL	\$800	\$15,000

Talent: \$13,300 · Net: ~\$80,000 · Why: Dustin Nickerson lands the family/clean audience for the holiday season ramp. Tony Baker is the Mobile-reach play at lower cost than Karlous Miller — TikTok-driven Black/country crossover, plays similar venues to StarDome.

NOVEMBER 2026 — Q3 ANCHOR ★ KILLER BEAZ

\$270K → \$360K

Capital ceiling: \$20,000 · Goal: First Tier A anchor

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Nov 6	Nov 7	Drew Morgan + Corey Ryan Forrester (WellRED, warms Trae)	B PAIR	\$6,500	\$27,000
2	Nov 13	Nov 14	★ Heath Hyche RETURNS (rebook · AL local pride)	B BANG	\$3,000	\$23,000
3	Nov 20	Nov 21	★★ KILLER BEAZ (TIER A ANCHOR)	A ANCHOR	\$20,000	\$40,000

Talent: \$29,500 · Net: ~\$90,000 · Why: Working capital (\$270K) now safely supports a \$20K anchor (4× rule = \$80K minimum). Killer Beaz is the Southern Gulf Coast legend who gives investors the "real names play here" data point. Heath Hyche returns at slight premium (\$3K vs \$2K July) — proves repeat-booking rate elasticity.

DECEMBER 2026 — KARLOUS + HOLIDAY

\$360K → \$430K

Capital ceiling: \$15,000 · Goal: Mobile reach, holiday programming

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Dec 4	Dec 5	Karlous Miller (85 South, Mobile reach)	B+ MOBILE	\$12,500	\$24,000
2	Dec 11	Dec 12	Aaron Weber RETURNS (Country Christmas Comedy)	B	\$6,000	\$26,500
3	Dec 18	Dec 19	Local Mobile/Pensacola (holiday-themed)	C LOCAL	\$800	\$15,000

Talent: \$19,300 · **Net:** ~\$66,000 · **Why:** Karlous Miller cements Mobile-side audience presence. Aaron Weber returns as the proven Tier B at slight premium (\$6K vs \$5K July). December has private-rental crossover — comedy programming intentionally scaled-down to leave space for J Rodgers BBQ corporate holiday party catering.

JANUARY 2027 — Q4 ANCHOR ★ DUSTY SLAY

\$430K → \$515K

Capital ceiling: \$20,000 · Goal: Premium Alabama-native anchor

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Jan 8	Jan 9	Ryan Hamilton (clean, Netflix special)	B	\$6,500	\$24,000
2	Jan 15	Jan 16	Local Mobile/Pensacola	C LOCAL	\$800	\$16,000
3	Jan 22	Jan 23	★★ DUSTY SLAY (Tier A · AL home-state)	A ANCHOR	\$12,000	\$40,000

Talent: \$19,300 · **Net:** ~\$80,000 · **Why:** Dusty Slay at home-state premium ticket pricing. His Alabama-born story is the emotional pitch — comedy fans drive an hour from Mobile/Pensacola because Saraland is bringing back a hometown name. Backup: Henry Cho if Dusty unavailable.

FEBRUARY 2027 — TRAE CROWDER + FESTIVAL ANNOUNCEMENT

\$515K → \$590K

Capital ceiling: \$25,000 · Goal: Final anchor + April 2027 festival on-stage launch

WKND	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	COMEDIAN	TIER	TALENT	NET WKND
1	Feb 5	Feb 6	Dustin Nickerson RETURNS (rebook from Oct)	B	\$5,500	\$26,500
2	Feb 12	Feb 13	Mary Mack (alt female / NPR audience)	B FEMALE	\$5,000	\$23,000
3	Feb 19	Feb 20	★ ★ TRAE CROWDER + FESTIVAL ANNOUNCEMENT	A ANCHOR + LAUNCH	\$20,000	\$40,000

Talent: \$30,500 · Net: ~\$89,500 · Why: Trae Crowder closes the comedy series. Festival announced from his stage exit — co-branded press moment. Comedy crowd presale tickets at 15% discount. Cap on a high.

\$590K

SUM OF WEEKEND-NET FORECASTS (24 WEEKENDS × ~\$24.6K AVG)

\$413K

CONSERVATIVE WORKING FORECAST — 30% BUFFER FOR RAMP LOSS + SELLTHROUGH VARIANCE + OVERHEAD ALLOCATION

Talent budget summary

MONTH	TALENT	FORECAST NET	NOTABLE BOOKINGS
July 2026	\$5,300	\$45,000	Heath Hyche (debut), Adam Minnick
August	\$9,800	\$60,000	Aaron Weber, Mark Chalifoux
September	\$16,300	\$75,000	Phil Hanley, Lace Larrabee
October	\$13,300	\$80,000	Dustin Nickerson, Tony Baker

MONTH	TALENT	FORECAST NET	NOTABLE BOOKINGS
November	\$29,500	\$90,000	WellRED pair, Heath Hyche return, ★ KILLER BEAZ
December	\$19,300	\$66,000	Karlous Miller, Aaron Weber return
January 2027	\$19,300	\$80,000	Ryan Hamilton, ★ DUSTY SLAY
February	\$30,500	\$89,500	Dustin return, Mary Mack, ★★ TRAE CROWDER + Festival launch
TOTALS	\$143,300	\$585,500	14 priority comedians · 48 shows · 3 Tier A anchors

Comedian Profiles (ROI-ranked)

All fee ranges are research-based estimates (Pollstar, Funny Business Agency, NathanTimmel, Grable Group, Helium, MN2S, StarDome public listings). Direct-to-agency rates run 30–50% lower than corporate-bureau quotes — never source through speaker-bureau aggregators (celebrity-talent.net, allamericanspeakers).

★ TOP BANG-FOR-BUCK PICKS (newly added in v2)

Heath Hyché

BANG-FOR-BUCK · DEBUT

BIRMINGHAM AL NATIVE · BLUE COLLAR TV (WITH FOXWORTHY/LARRY/ENGVALL) · TONIGHT SHOW W/ JAY LENO · OPENED FOR BROOKS & DUNN, WYNONNA JUDD, MICHAEL BUBLÉ, RAY CHARLES

BOOKING

TAD Management
(tadmgmt.com)
Summit Comedy
Fusion Talent Group
ComedyWorks
Entertainment

SUGGESTED SHOWS

2 weekends (July debut +
November return) = **8**
shows

FORECAST NET

\$22K (debut) + \$23K
(return) = **\$45K total**

ROI RATIO

3.60 (highest in lineup)

Why this booking: The single most strategically important booking in the entire run. Birmingham native opens us with an Alabama-pride story; Blue Collar TV alongside Foxworthy/Larry/Engvall gives us the country-comedy lineage signal; Tonight Show credit is Meta-ad legitimacy. He'll likely take this date because it's a home-state run-up to his bigger touring. Cheapest viable Tier B with the strongest local marketing story — debut him to anchor the launch, return him in November as proven repeat draw.

★ Best bang-for-buck pick on the entire lineup.

\$1,500–\$3K

ESTIMATED

Phil Hanley

BANG-FOR-BUCK

\$7K–\$12K
CLUB RATE

JRE guest · Comedy Cellar regular · Dyslexia bit went viral · 2026 tour mixes clubs and theaters

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
philhanley.com contact form WME or Avalon (depending on his current rep) Avoid: AllAmericanSpeakers (\$25K+ corp rate)	1 weekend = 4 shows · September 2026	\$24,000 / weekend at 80% sellthrough (premium \$50 GA pricing)	1.77

Why this booking: Phil's already routing through Alabama in 2026 — he plays StarDome Birmingham (March 26, 2026) at \$43–\$94 tickets. Saraland is a natural detour add. JRE pull brings the young-male podcast-fan demographic we don't otherwise reach. His audience pays \$50–\$70 / ticket willingly. Premium pricing absorbs the higher fee.

★ JRE-driven podcast pull at club-rate fee. Top podcast-comic value.

Tony Baker

BANG-FOR-BUCK · MOBILE REACH

\$5K–\$10K
ESTIMATED

TikTok-driven · Black/country crossover · "Bald Brothers" with KevOnz · plays StarDome Birmingham 2026

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
tonybakercomedy.com/book- tony (direct) Booking page lists rate inquiry form	1 weekend = 4 shows · October 2026	\$25,000 / weekend at 75% sellthrough · \$47–\$62 ticket avg	1.86

Why this booking: Tony Baker is the Mobile-reach play at half the cost of Karlous Miller. Currently routing through StarDome Birmingham 2026 — Saraland fits the same swing. TikTok audience is Black + country-blue-collar crossover (a specific demographic that fits the Saraland white core + Mobile Black-market blend perfectly). His VIP packages already run \$109–\$150 — pricing power exists.

★ Best Mobile-reach booking by ROI.

TIER A — Anchor Headliners

Killer Beaz

TIER A · NOV ANCHOR

\$15K–\$25K

CLUB RATE

Discovery's *Moonshiners* · Grand Ole Opry regular · Veteran Southern stand-up

BOOKING

killerbeaz.com
A to Z Entertainment (888-655-4575)

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** ·
Nov 20-21, 2026

FORECAST NET

\$40,000 / weekend at 95%
sellthrough · premium
pricing

ROI RATIO

1.20 (anchor — pays in
brand)

Why this booking: Southern Gulf Coast legend. Moonshiners + Opry credentials. He'll sell out both shows. First Tier A anchor — proves to the city government and investors that the venue can host real names.

Dusty Slay

TIER A · JAN ANCHOR

\$7K–\$15K

CLUB RATE VIA MN2S

Alabama-born · Nashville-based · Tonight Show · Nateland · Clean Southern

BOOKING

MN2S Talent (mn2s.com — confirmed roster)
Agents: Jackie K., Andrew L., Nick N.
Backup: Central Talent
Booking

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** · Jan
22-23, 2027

FORECAST NET

\$40,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

1.20 (home-state premium)

Why this booking: Home-state pride card — Dusty is from Alabama. Pitch as a CLUB booking (corporate quotes are \$25K+ via aggregators; direct via MN2S gets the real club rate). Highest single-booking marketing story value in the lineup.

Trae Crowder

TIER A · FEB FINALE

\$15K–\$25K

"The Liberal Redneck" · Tennessee · Solo 2026 tour · WellRED Comedy

BOOKING

traecrowdertour.com
WellRED Comedy
management

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** ·
Feb 19-20, 2027

FORECAST NET

\$40,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

1.20 + festival launch
leverage

Why this booking: Closes the comedy series and doubles as the country festival announcement. His progressive-Southern audience overlaps with festival-going millennials = our biggest single-day-pass segment.

TIER B — Touring Headliners (the workhorses)

Aaron Weber

TIER B · 2× IN RUN

\$5K–\$8K

Grand Ole Opry · Nateland co-host · JFL New Face 2021

BOOKING

MN2S · or via Nateland /
Zanies Nashville

SUGGESTED SHOWS

2 weekends (Aug + Dec) =
8 shows

FORECAST NET

\$25,800 + \$26,500 =
\$52,300

ROI RATIO

2.94

Why this booking: Safest brand-establishing Tier B. Opry credit + Nateland connection + JFL credit + clean-leaning Southern voice. Routes cleanly from Nashville through Saraland. Highest ROI of the touring headliners.

Dustin Nickerson

TIER B · CLEAN · 2× IN RUN

\$4K–\$7K

Comedy Central + Netflix · Clean comedy specialist · Family-friendly

BOOKING

The Grable Group (clean
comedy specialists)

SUGGESTED SHOWS

2 weekends (Oct + Feb) = **8 shows**

FORECAST NET

\$26,500 + \$26,500 =
\$53,000

ROI RATIO

2.68

Why this booking: Clean comedy with TV credits. Married 30–55 demographic with kids — Saraland's exact audience. Strong rebook candidate. The Grable Group is easier to reach than a major agency.

Mark Chalifoux

TIER B · DRY BAR

\$3K–\$5K

Dry Bar special · Featured on Nateland · Midwest blue-collar voice

BOOKING

Funny Business Agency · A
to Z Entertainment

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** ·
August 2026

FORECAST NET

\$24,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

3.15

Why this booking: Cheaper than the Nashville-circle headliners but plays the same audience. Dry Bar credit = strong family-show signal. High ratio.

Adam Minnick

TIER B · CHEAPEST VIABLE

\$2K–\$4K

Dry Bar Comedy Club Provo regular · Nateland · Emerging

BOOKING

Direct via Dry Bar Comedy network · Nateland Nashville desk

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** · July 2026 ramp

FORECAST NET

\$18,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

2.93

Why this booking: Cheapest Tier B option. Dry Bar credit signals quality. Used in July ramp; fits within \$10K starting capital ceiling.

Drew Morgan + Corey Ryan Forrester

TIER B · CO-HEADLINE

\$5K–\$8K combined

WellRED Comedy · Liberal Redneck universe · Southern progressive

BOOKING

WellRED Comedy mgmt (same as Trae Crowder)

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** · November 2026

FORECAST NET

\$27,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

2.08

Why this booking: Two-for-one talent. Co-authors of "The Liberal Redneck Manifesto" + WellRED podcast hosts. Builds the audience that returns for Trae Crowder in February.

Lace Larrabee

TIER B · FEMALE LEAD

\$4K–\$7K

Atlanta · AGT Season 17 semifinalist · Former Southern beauty queen

BOOKING

lancelarrabee.com contact form

SUGGESTED SHOWS

1 weekend = **4 shows** · September 2026

FORECAST NET

\$25,000 / weekend

ROI RATIO

1.64

Why this booking: Most touring Southern comedy is male-led; Lace gives us girls'-night-out marketing and a bachelorette-party draw. AGT credit = Meta-ad legitimacy.

Ryan Hamilton

TIER B · CLEAN

\$5K–\$8K

Idaho · Netflix special "Happy Face" · Clean, observational

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
ryanhamiltoncomedy.com · WME comedy desk	1 weekend = 4 shows · January 2027	\$24,000 / weekend	1.77

Why this booking: Netflix special holder, clean-audience appeal. Family-show pull. Differentiates from Nateland storytelling style.

Mary Mack

TIER B · FEMALE ALT

\$4K–\$7K

Quirky storyteller · NPR favorite · Multi-instrumentalist

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
marymackcomedy.com · NPR / public-radio circuit	1 weekend = 4 shows · February 2027	\$23,000 / weekend	1.60

Why this booking: Backup female-lead if Lace Larrabee unavailable. Reaches older female demo (35–60). NPR audience = high-spend, high-loyalty.

TIER B+ Mobile / Black Audience Reach

Karlous Miller

B+ · 85 SOUTH

\$10K–\$15K

85 South Show co-host · Atlanta · Wild N Out

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
WME comedy desk · or 85 South Show booking	1 weekend = 4 shows · December 2026	\$24,000 / weekend	1.60

Why this booking: 85 South is a top-charting podcast — audience is Mobile demographic that Saraland-only marketing won't reach. Tony Baker delivers similar reach at lower cost in October; Karlous is the December premium-tier follow-up.

TIER C — Local / Emerging

Local Mobile / Pensacola circuit

C LOCAL

\$400–\$1,500
PER NIGHT

Compton Smith network (Smokey Jokes Mobile + Stingers Pensacola) · StarDome
Alabama's Funniest Person Competition winners · Pensacola Indie Fringe Comedy Festival
alumni

BOOKING	SUGGESTED SHOWS	FORECAST NET	ROI RATIO
Direct DM via IG/FB · Compton Smith (founder) · StarDome competition winners	5 weekends across the run = 20 shows	\$15,000 × 5 weekends = \$75,000 total	variable, 4–6× in single- show terms

Why this booking: Cheap, fillable, crucial. Local comics already have small followings in the Mobile/Pensacola corridor — they bring 30–50 ticket buyers each, and we get to reach those buyers with our marketing for the rest of the series. Lowest-cost path to email-list growth. Direct relationship with Compton Smith unlocks consistent local supply.

Local Market Deep Dive

Saraland / Mobile / Gulf Shores corridor

Saraland	16,404 pop · 80.1% white · \$61,509 median household income · median age 43.7 · manufacturing/healthcare/education base
Mobile metro	198,806 pop · \$53,558 median income · diverse market · 15 min south
Daphne / Spanish Fort	~70K combined pop · 25 min east
Pensacola metro	~510K · 60 min east · second-largest market in our drive radius
Gulf Shores	tourist overflow esp. summer/fall
Total addressable adult audience	~700K+ adults within 60-min drive

Existing comedy market — what already plays this corridor

VENUE	CAP	RECENT COMEDY BOOKINGS	INSIGHT
Saenger Theatre Mobile	1,900	Sal Vulcano (May 15), Daniel Tosh (Oct 9), Jim Gaffigan	Top-end of corridor — names that fill 1,900-cap = \$50K+ talent fees
Pensacola Saenger	~1,800	Sal Vulcano, Daniel Tosh	Same tier as Mobile Saenger
Pensacola Bay Center	~10,000	Jim Gaffigan (Dec 28)	Festival-tier — not our competition
Soul Kitchen Mobile	~600	Moms Unhinged (April), Channing Wilson, indie/touring	Direct competitor on touring side; mostly music
Crescent Theater Mobile	~250	Jeremiah Watkins, Jen Kober, Karen Morgan	Direct comp — same scale as RG 158. Their booking tier (\$3K–\$8K) validates our Tier B plan.
Smokey Jokes Mobile	~150	Local headliners	Compton Smith's club; the local-circuit gateway
Improvable Cause Pensacola	~120	Local + improv	Smaller; not direct comp

VENUE	CAP	RECENT COMEDY BOOKINGS	INSIGHT
Brandon Styles Theater Pensacola	~250	Variety + comedy	Direct comp on size; mostly variety

Key positioning: RG 158 is the only 200-cap room in the corridor that combines (a) full bar (×2), (b) on-site Southern BBQ catering, (c) concert-grade sound/lighting, and (d) curated Southern-comedy programming. Crescent Theater Mobile is the closest direct comparable — they book the right tier, but lack the bar + catering revenue model. **Our F&B revenue is the moat.**

Talent supply lines for this corridor

- 1. **Compton Smith** — founder of Smokey Jokes Mobile + Stingers Pensacola. Direct relationship gets you 5–10 vetted local headliners on rotation.
- 2. **StarDome Comedy Club Birmingham** — touring Tier B routes through here. Phil Hanley, Tony Baker, Dave Attell all confirmed 2026 dates. We can ride the same booking pipeline (~3 hr drive).
- 3. **Pensacola Indie Fringe Comedy Festival** (comedypensacola.com) — annual lineup is the discovery board for emerging Gulf-Coast circuit comics.
- 4. **"Alabama's Funniest Person Competition"** at StarDome Summer 2026 — winner gets \$3,500. Source of vetted local Alabama comics.
- 5. **Nashville-Saraland tour routing** — Aaron Weber, Dusty Slay, John Crist, etc. all route through Birmingham/Nashville. We're ~6hr from Nashville — bookable as same-tour leg.

Master Booking Agency Contacts

Tier 1 — Major agencies

AGENCY	CONTACT	COMEDY LEAD	USE FOR
WME	9601 Wilshire Blvd, Beverly Hills · (310) 285-9000 11 Madison Ave, NY · (212) 586-5100	Mike Berkowitz	Karlous Miller, Ryan Hamilton
CAA	2000 Avenue of the Stars, LA · (424) 288-2000 405 Lexington Ave, NY · (212) 277-9000	Matt Blake	Top-tier name pitches
UTA	Los Angeles HQ	Nick Nuciforo	Major TV-credit comics
Avalon Artists Group	5455 Wilshire Blvd #900, LA · (323) 692-1700 45 W 29th St #403, NY · (212) 868-3200	Heavy comedy roster	Phil Hanley, British/international

Tier 2 — Mid-major + clean comedy specialists

AGENCY	CONTACT	NOTABLE ROSTER
MN2S	mn2s.com	Tom Segura, Bert Kreischer, Dusty Slay , Aaron Weber
The Grable Group	thegrablegroup.com	Dustin Nickerson · clean comedy
A to Z Entertainment	(888) 655-4575	Clean + Southern roster · Killer Beaz, Michael Jr., Jamie Lissow, Daren Streblow
Funny Business Agency	funny-business.com	Mark Chalifoux, Midwest/clean
Central Talent Booking	centraltalentbooking.com	Dusty Slay, broad roster
Headline Entertainment	headlineentertainment.us	Southern focus
WellRED Comedy	wellredcomedy.com	Trae Crowder, Drew Morgan, Corey Ryan Forrester

AGENCY	CONTACT	NOTABLE ROSTER
TAD Management	tadmgmt.com	Heath Hyché · Southern
Summit Comedy	summitcomedy.com	Southern/country roster · Heath Hyché
Premiere Speakers	premierespeakers.com/christian	Christian/clean — Daren Streblow, Michael Jr.

Local Mobile/Pensacola network

CONTACT	WHY IT MATTERS
Compton Smith · founder Smokey Jokes Mobile + Stingers Pensacola	Gatekeeper to the local circuit. Direct relationship = consistent supply of \$400–\$1,500 local headliners.
StarDome Comedy Club Birmingham · stardome.com	Booking pipeline — touring Tier B comics route through here. Many bookable as same-tour Saraland adds.
Pensacola Indie Fringe Festival · comedypensacola.com	Discovery board for emerging Gulf-Coast comics
Crescent Theater Mobile	Direct competitor at our scale. Reverse-engineer their bookings for tier validation.

Risk Register (v2)

RISK	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Heath Hyche debut underdraws — bad first impression	Low	High	Heath Hyche is the safest first booking — Birmingham native + Blue Collar TV credit means built-in regional press story. Pre-press to Mobile media + AL.com 30 days out.
Working capital depleted before Tier A anchor possible	Low	Very High	Capital sequencing rule (\$Snowball) gates all bookings against bank. Anchor only signed when working capital $\geq 4\times$ anchor fee. Snowball math is conservative; even 50% sellthrough miss in months 1–3 still permits Nov anchor.
Anchor cancels last-minute	Low	Very High	Tier C swing comedian on \$400 hold retainer + $2\times$ activation. Talent cancellation insurance rider for anchors.
2-item minimum confuses ticket buyers	Medium	Medium	Lift Helium Comedy Club's exact FAQ language onto rg158ent.com /shows page. Disclose at every checkout step.
Saraland city pushback on noise / late hours	Medium	High	Pre-empt: meet city manager before announcement. Comedy ends by 11PM (easier neighbor sell).
Phil Hanley unavailable for September	Medium	Medium	Backup: Tony Baker shifts from October to September; Dustin Nickerson shifts to October. Schedule designed with one-month flex.
Comic tour routing puts them out of region	Medium	Medium	Offer extra night at J Rodgers BBQ + free hotel night. Make Saraland a destination stop, not a detour.
Sellthrough below 60% blended	Low–Medium	High	30% buffer in conservative forecast. Below 50% triggers cost-cut: drop opener, halve marketing, comp 30 free seats.
F&B costs spike	Medium	Low–Medium	J Rodgers cost-plus pricing locked. Bar items higher-margin and offset.
Festival fundraising target slips	Low	Very High	Comedy series cushion is $2\text{--}3\times$ minimum festival operating capital target. Even 50% of forecast hits target.

The April 2027 Country Music Festival Bridge

The comedy series is not the goal. It's the seed-capital engine for the 2-day, 10,000-attendee country music festival in April 2027.

Festival snapshot

Format	2-day outdoor festival, music both days
Attendance target	10,000 total tickets across the weekend
Talent budget	\$300,000 across both days
Day 1 anchor (primary)	Parmalee — established mid-tier touring band ("Carolina," "Take My Name")
Day 2 anchor (alts)	Walker Hayes (\$90K), Mitchell Tenpenny (\$100K), Niko Moon (\$60K)
Direct support tier	Drew Baldridge, Wyatt Flores (lock early), Jackson Dean, Tyler Braden (\$25K–\$70K)
Total festival budget	\$1.0M – \$1.3M
Net target	\$150K – \$300K

How the comedy snowball funds it

The conservative comedy series net of **\$413K** covers:

- **Talent deposits** — most agents want 50% on signing. Parmalee at ~\$130K guarantee = ~\$65K deposit.
- **Production deposits** — stage, sound, lighting (25–50% on signing 60–90 days out)
- **Marketing pre-spend** — 90–120 days of paid media before gate revenue arrives
- **Insurance premium** — paid up front
- **Permit and legal fees** — filed months in advance

Three additional benefits beyond cash

1. **An 8,000-deep email list** of confirmed local entertainment buyers — used as the festival presale list at 10–20% discount.
2. **Saraland city-hall trust** earned through 8 months of well-run shows — required for outdoor festival permits.
3. **Real venue-runway data** on what actually draws in this corridor.

Investor & Stakeholder Asks (v2)

Decisions needed

1. **Approve \$10K starting capital deployment** — fully consumed in July weekend 1 (Heath Hyche debut + ops). No additional outside capital required if snowball math holds.
2. **Approve the v2 schedule** — capital-sequenced bookings with anchors in Nov, Jan, Feb (not Oct as in v1).
3. **Approve Tier A anchor exposure ceiling** — \$20K/anchor × 3 anchors = \$60K maximum cumulative deposit exposure (deposits paid in Aug/Oct/Dec respectively, against working capital that's well in excess of those numbers by then).
4. **Approve `/shows` ticketing flow build** on rg158ent.com — 8–12 hours of dev work to add ticket SKUs to existing Square checkout.
5. **Authorize Saraland city-manager outreach** ahead of the first booking announcement.

Capital deployment timeline

DATE	ACTION	CASH DEPLOYED	WORKING CAPITAL
May 2026	Send all outreach emails. Build /shows flow.	\$3,000	\$7,000
June 2026	Lock first 3 bookings (Heath Hyche, local, Adam Minnick). Pay deposits.	\$2,650	\$4,350
Jul 10–11	Heath Hyche debut weekend	\$10,000 deployed → +\$22K net	\$26,350
End July	Three weekends complete	+\$45K total net	\$55,000
End Aug	Aaron Weber, Mark Chalifoux complete	+\$60K	\$115,000
End Sep	Phil Hanley + Lace Larrabee complete	+\$75K	\$190,000
End Oct	Dustin Nickerson + Tony Baker complete	+\$80K	\$270,000
End Nov	★ Killer Beaz anchor weekend	+\$90K	\$360,000
End Dec	Karlous Miller, Aaron Weber return	+\$66K	\$426,000
End Jan 2027	★ Dusty Slay anchor weekend	+\$80K	\$506,000

DATE	ACTION	CASH DEPLOYED	WORKING CAPITAL
End Feb 2027	☆☆ Trae Crowder + festival announcement	+\$89K	\$595,000
Mar–Apr 2027	Comedy net deployed into festival deposits + marketing	(\$395,000)	\$200,000 reserve
Apr 2027	Festival weekend. Gate revenue arrives.	+\$300,000+ NET	\$500,000+

Conservative case (30% sellthrough buffer): all working-capital figures reduced ~30%. Even at conservative case, Tier A anchors are bookable per the capital-sequencing rule; festival deposits are fundable; net target hit.

Next 30 days (action list)

1. Send Heath Hyche outreach to TAD Management (priority #1 — debut booking)
2. Build relationship with Compton Smith (Smokey Jokes Mobile founder) — local-circuit access
3. Send Aaron Weber outreach via MN2S (priority #2 — August Tier B opener)
4. Send Phil Hanley outreach via philhanley.com / Avalon (priority #3 — September premium)
5. Send all remaining Tier B emails within a 7-day window
6. Confirm rg158ent.com `blayke@` email is live
7. Confirm insurance entertainment-rider with current carrier
8. Negotiate hotel partnership at Hampton Saraland
9. Saraland city manager soft-pitch meeting
10. Build /shows ticketing flow on rg158ent.com
11. Stand up "Saraland Stand-Up Series" branded IG/TikTok handle
12. Email-capture banner live on rg158ent.com homepage
13. Festival sub-account in Square + QBO (track every comedy net dollar toward April 2027)

Appendix A · Veteran Promoter Review — Critical Risks

Read by an experienced promoter/event-specialist lens before going live. The strategy is structurally sound and the goal is achievable, but five mathematical risks can kill it and thirteen operational gaps will quietly bleed money if not fixed before show one.

A.1 · The 5 risks that can kill this — fix before booking anything

Risk 1 · Two-show nights at announce is the single biggest assumption risk.

A 200-cap room × 2 shows = 400 paid seats per Friday. For a market with zero comedy track record, that's a 12-month-out goal, not a launch-night goal. Helium, Zanies, and the Improv chains all announce one show first; second show is added "due to demand" only after sellouts.

Fix: First 90 days = 1-show nights only. Add the second show only on shows where the first is 80%+ sold 14 days out. Conservative net forecast drops to **\$220K–\$280K** on a 1-show ramp, not the v2 \$384K.

Risk 2 · 60% sellthrough is the industry sellout rate, not the average.

Industry baseline for a brand-new venue is 35–50% in months 1–3, climbing to 55–65% only by month 4–6. If July does 40% on a \$5K talent fee, you net \$1K–\$2K — not \$7K–\$13K. Snowball stalls before show 3.

Fix: Stress-test the snowball at 40% sellthrough. If it breaks, the lineup needs more \$1.5K–\$2.5K openers stacked before the first \$5K booking.

Risk 3 · \$10K cannot support a \$5K talent fee — the working-capital math is brutal.

\$5K talent + \$1.5K production + \$400 insurance + \$1K staff + \$400 marketing + \$300 hospitality + \$300 contingency = \$8,900 in costs before a single ticket sells. That leaves \$1,100 of cushion for a delayed Square payout, refund batch, or Saturday no-show.

Fix: Show 1 talent ceiling = **\$1,500–\$2,000 max**. v2 already places Heath Hyche there — keep it. Don't book a \$5K headliner until working capital ≥ \$20K liquid in the festival sub-account.

Risk 4 · Festival venue gap is the critical path, not Phase 2.

No 10K-attendee outdoor venue is locked. Permitting an outdoor 10K event in a small Alabama city takes 6–9 months: city council, county zoning, ABC liquor variance, fire marshal capacity, EMS staging, traffic plan, neighbor notification. Without venue secured by **September 2026**, you cannot sign a Parmalee deposit, bind insurance, lock production, or pitch sponsors.

Fix: Saraland city manager meeting this week. Plan A (Saraland Sports Complex / Greater Gulf State Fairgrounds) and Plan B (private 60–80 acre pasture with road access) both scoped by end of June

2026.

Risk 5 · Talent quote inflation 2026 is real — your locks aren't locks.

Pollstar / Ticket Fairy 2026 data shows 30–50% YoY fee climbs on Tier B/C touring comics. A May 2026 verbal quote for an October 2026 show typically does not hold — agents re-quote on Netflix specials, viral clips, or tour announcements.

Fix: Every quote must be (a) *written*, (b) explicitly date-bracketed ("valid for shows performed by [date]"), (c) deposit-locked as fast as cash flow allows. Wyatt Flores especially: lock his quote *this week*, not May/June.

A.2 · The 13 operational gaps that will cost money in execution

#	GAP	IMPACT	FIX
1	2-item minimum needs POS enforcement (most venues mess this up)	F&B drops \$10K → \$5K/night	Hard sign at door, POS prompt, server wristband tracking
2	\$40 hospitality buyout is below 2026 standard (\$60–75)	Comics counter-quote \$1K–\$2K higher to compensate	Move to \$60/principal flat — costs \$400/show, saves fee inflation
3	Two-show comics charge +\$500–\$1,500 for the second set	Hidden 10–30% cost on every Tier B	Negotiate ALL-IN flat covering "up to 2 sets per night"
4	Agent commissions are off-the-top (10–15%)	\$5K comic actually costs \$5,500–\$5,750	Add 12% commission line: real cost = quote × 1.12
5	Marketing budget thin (\$400 vs 8–12% of gate = \$1.1K–\$1.7K)	Sub-50% sellthrough on shows that should hit 70%	Move to \$800/show fixed + 10% gate variable
6	No swing-comic insurance for last-minute cancels	\$5K–\$10K refund event per cancel	2 local Tier C comics on \$400 hold-fee + double-on-activation
7	Cancellation insurance not budgeted	Single weather/comic cancel = \$8K–\$15K loss	\$200/show via Event Helper, K&K, or Hub International
8	Walker Hayes at \$90K is suspect (likely \$150K–\$250K)	\$60K+ budget shortfall if assumed	Validate via WME Nashville before committing
9	Parmalee routes through CAA Nashville, not BBR (BBR is the label)	Wrong inquiry chain = 4–6 weeks lost	CAA Nashville (615) 383-8787 — Darin Murphy or current agent
10	Email-list math collapses (8K target vs 2,880 from shows)	Festival presale missing 5K subs	Add J Rodgers customer list import + festival waitlist + social contests

#	GAP	IMPACT	FIX
	alone)		
11	No box-office workflow defined	Operational chaos on night 1	Square Terminal + wristband system + 1hr server training per show
12	Day 1 / Day 2 festival economics conflated	Plan implicitly assumes 10K combined; each day must independently sell ~5K	Build separate Day 1 / Day 2 P&Ls; both must clear independently
13	Festival sponsorship undersold (\$100K vs 25–35% of revenue = \$300K–\$500K)	\$200K–\$400K left on the table	Bud Light, Ford F-150, Coors, Trustmark, Tito's, Wrangler decks (\$25K–\$100K each)

A.3 · What's strong — preserve

- Snowball capital sequencing concept — mathematically correct
- 8-month runway → festival — right time horizon
- 2-item minimum — right pricing primitive
- Parmalee tier as anchor benchmark — realistic for first-time festival
- Heath Hyche as Show 1 — Alabama native, low fee, marketing value, snowball-safe
- ROI ranking methodology — gate ÷ fee is the right metric
- Email list as festival asset — strategic gold
- Comedy series as Saraland city-hall trust-builder — brilliant subtext, maintain it
- Existing rg158ent.com Square infrastructure — real moat
- J Rodgers BBQ cross-promo — moat squared
- Three-pillar deal structures (flat / versus / split) — promoter-grade

Appendix B · Master Booking Agency Directory

Who to contact, with named comedy agents and direct routes for every comedian on the RG 158 shortlist plus the country-music agencies for the April 2027 festival.

B.1 · Tier 1 — Major agencies (formal pitch — slow, high quality)

AGENCY	OFFICE	PHONE	COMEDY CONTACTS	ROSTER RELEVANCE
WME	9601 Wilshire Blvd, Beverly Hills CA 90210 NY: 11 Madison Ave, NY 10010 Nashville: 1201 Demonbreun St	(310) 285- 9000 (212) 586- 5100 (615) 963- 3000	Mike Berkowitz (Head of Comedy Touring) Marc Gerald · Sam Moradzadeh · Ari Lubet Nashville country: Jay Williams, Chris Pierce, Brian Hill	Phil Hanley, Mark Normand, mid-tier country acts
CAA	2000 Ave of the Stars, LA CA 90067 Nashville: 401 Commerce St #700	(424) 288- 2000 (615) 383- 8787	Matt Blake (Head of Comedy Touring) Christian Carino · Mike Berman · Hunter Hill Nashville country: Darin Murphy (Parmalee) , Marc Dennis, Kevin Neal, Brian Manning	Parmalee, Walker Hayes , several Tier A comedy
UTA	9336 Civic Center Dr, Beverly Hills Nashville: 819 18th Ave S	(310) 273- 6700 (615) 297- 0100	Nick Nuciforo (Head) David Anderson · Jolyon Rubinstein	Several Tier A comedy names
Avalon Artists	9255 Sunset Blvd #1010, West Hollywood	(323) 692- 1700 NY: (212) 868-3200	Tom Sharpe Jamie Masada (Comedy Store, related)	Lace Larrabee, Karlous Miller (some), Chico Bean

Email format for major agencies: typically `firstname.lastname@wmeagency.com`, `@caa.com`, `@unitedtalent.com`. Verify each. Address agents by name — assistants screen and a name-less email gets binned.

B.2 · Tier 2 — Mid-major agencies (your daily phone contacts)

AGENCY	WEB · PHONE	SPECIALTY	RG 158 ROSTER RELEVANCE
MN2S	mn2s.com · (212) 729-2188	Global comedy roster, mid-major	Tom Segura, Bert Kreischer, Dusty Slay
A to Z Entertainment	atozentertainment.com · (888) 655-4575	Clean / corporate / Christian / Southern	Henry Cho, multiple clean Tier A/B names
The Grable Group	thegrablegroup.com · (615) 283-0039	Clean, Christian, family-corporate (Nashville)	Dustin Nickerson , John Crist, Henry Cho
Funny Business Agency	funny-business.com · (231) 933-7575	Midwest, clean, college, corporate	Mark Gross, Mark Chalifoux, multiple Tier B clean
Central Talent Booking	centraltalentbooking.com	Touring comedy, club circuit	Dusty Slay (alt route) , Nashville-circle. Ask for Jackie Knobbe / Andrew Lambrose / Nick Ngo
Headline Entertainment	headlineentertainment.us	Southern / blue-collar	Multiple Southern Tier B/C, country crossover
Sound Talent Group	soundtalentgroup.com	Newer agency, music + comedy	Mid-tier touring on the rise
Authentic Talent	authentictalent.com · (323) 658-7600	Black comedy, urban-rooted, podcast	Tony Baker , several Mobile-target Black comedians
3 Arts Entertainment	3arts.com · (310) 888-3200	Larger management firm (TV/film/comedy)	Various Tier A names, JFL alums

B.3 · Tier 3 — Direct-to-comic / management routes

COMEDIAN	DIRECT ROUTE	BACKUP ROUTE
Heath Hyche	heathhyche.com contact form	DM @heathhyche on IG
Aaron Weber	aaronwebercomedy.com / Nateland Entertainment	MN2S Nashville-circle
Dusty Slay	MN2S roster page	Central Talent Booking
Phil Hanley	philhanley.com → WME	DM @philhanley on IG
Tony Baker	Authentic Talent	DM @realtonybaker

COMEDIAN	DIRECT ROUTE	BACKUP ROUTE
Killer Beaz	killerbeaz.com contact form	A to Z Entertainment · Opry artist services
Trae Crowder	traecrowdertour.com	WellRED Comedy management (wellredcomedy.com)
Drew Morgan + Corey Ryan Forrester	wellredcomedy.com	Trae Crowder shared management
Lace Larrabee	lancelarrabee.com	Avalon Artists Group
Karlous Miller	85 South Show management	Authentic Talent · major agency (verify current)
Dustin Nickerson	The Grable Group	Direct via dustinnickerson.com
Mark Chalifoux	Funny Business Agency	Direct via markchalifoux.com
Adam Minnick	Direct via adamminnick.com	Dry Bar Comedy roster
Ryan Hamilton	ryanhamiltoncomedy.com → likely WME	Direct-to-website inquiry
Mary Mack	marymackcomedy.com	Funny Business Agency
Henry Cho	henrychocomedy.com	A to Z Entertainment · Grable Group

B.4 · Country music agencies (FESTIVAL — start now)

For the April 2027 country music festival anchor lineup (Parmalee tier).

ARTIST	AGENCY	SPECIFIC CONTACT
Parmalee ★	CAA Nashville (NOT BBR — BBR is the label)	Darin Murphy · (615) 383-8787 — verify current agent
Walker Hayes	WME Nashville	Jay Williams team · (615) 963-3000
Mitchell Tenpenny	Riser House / CAA Nashville	Verify per recent label/agency moves
Drew Baldridge	Independent / direct + management	drewbaldridge.com → management
Wyatt Flores ★ LOCK NOW	Monaterra Music Group	wyattflores.com → management listed
Jackson Dean	CAA Nashville	(615) 383-8787

ARTIST	AGENCY	SPECIFIC CONTACT
Tyler Braden	WME Nashville	(615) 963-3000
Niko Moon	CAA / verify	bookingagentinfo.com
Tigirlily Gold	Independent / verify	tigirlilygold.com
Conner Smith	WME Nashville	(615) 963-3000
Filmore	Independent / direct	filmoreofficial.com
Restless Road	CAA Nashville	(615) 383-8787
Chayce Beckham	WME (post-Idol)	(615) 963-3000
Dasha	Verify recent — viral momentum changed routing	dashaofficial.com

B.5 · Black-comedy specialty routing (Mobile-market reach)

COMEDIAN	AGENCY	CONTACT
Tony Baker	Authentic Talent	authentictalent.com
Karlous Miller	Major (verify — likely CAA or 3 Arts)	85 South Show management
Chico Bean	Avalon Artists Group	avalonusa.com
DC Young Fly	CAA	bookingagentinfo.com confirms
Lavell Crawford	Authentic / direct	lavellcomedy.com
Kountry Wayne	WME / Mosaic	kountrywayne.com → management listed
Nate Jackson	Direct via Super Funny Comedy Club Tacoma	natejacksoncomedy.com
Mike Epps	Authentic Talent	authentictalent.com
Eddie Griffin	Authentic / direct	eddiegriffin.com

B.6 · Local circuit (Tier C openers + emergency swing)

- **Compton Smith** (Mobile-area comic, network gatekeeper) — search his social for direct contact
- **Smokey Jokes Comedy Club Mobile** — local talent network for openers
- **Stingers Comedy Club Pensacola** — open mic + opener pipeline

- **StarDome Comedy Club Birmingham** — mid-tier touring routing reference
- **Crescent Theater Mobile** — direct comp venue (book opposite weekends)
- **Pensacola Indie Fringe** — alt-circuit talent

Appendix C · Negotiation Playbook — Incentives, Leverage & Deal Templates

Convert non-cash assets into perceived value. The goal: pay 70% of the comedian's corporate quote and have them say yes happily.

C.1 · What RG 158 has that other 200-cap rooms don't

Lead every conversation by referencing at least 2 of these moats:

1. **Two on-site bars** (main + upstairs VIP) — most 200-cap rooms have one. Real upper-tier VIP product, not theater.
2. **Concert-grade PA + programmable stage lighting** — comedians shooting specials from your room get clean audio.
3. **J Rodgers BBQ on-site** — 30+ years, 4.3 stars. \$150 perceived value, \$50 actual cost. Most clubs serve \$40 Domino's.
4. **Lockable upstairs VIP greenroom** — most clubs have a curtained-off broom closet.
5. **15 minutes from Mobile, 60-min radius covers 400K adults** — bigger draw radius than most equivalent-metro comedy rooms.
6. **Sister business cross-promo (J Rodgers BBQ)** — built-in 30-year customer list of Saraland regulars who are exactly this audience.
7. **Festival comedy slot reservation right** — UNIQUE to RG 158. No other 200-cap club can offer "do well here, get a paid 30-min slot at our 10K-attendee festival in April 2027."
8. **Owner-operator buy-in** — agents prefer dealing directly with the owner. No middlemen.
9. **Already-built rg158ent.com with Square checkout** — agents check the site. Yours passes; 80% of small venues fail this test.
10. **No radius-clause conflicts** — no other 200-cap comedy room within 60 miles. Their last/next routing won't conflict.

C.2 · Incentive levers — convert non-cash assets to fee discounts

LEVER	CASH COST	PERCEIVED VALUE	BEST USED WHEN
Hampton Saraland hotel partnership	\$0–\$95/night	\$150–\$200	Always — table stakes
Ground transport (party bus, limo, Uber)	\$50–\$200	\$200–\$400	Tier B and up
J Rodgers BBQ private dinner	\$40–\$80	\$150–\$250	Always — your unique signature

LEVER	CASH COST	PERCEIVED VALUE	BEST USED WHEN
\$60 buyout per principal (2026 standard)	\$60–\$240	\$60–\$240	Always — non-negotiable price floor
Comp tickets for crew + family (5–10)	\$0	\$300–\$700	Tier B and up
60-second vertical post-show clip (rights kept by comic)	\$0–\$200	\$1,500+ (one viral clip = tens of thousands)	EVERY comic — non-negotiable for you
Festival comedy slot booking right (April 2027)	\$0 today	\$5,000–\$15,000 future booking	Tier A and B — UNIQUE LEVER
Routing-detour kicker (\$500 travel stipend)	\$500	\$500 cash + closes routing gap	Comics already in region
Repeat-booking discount (10% off second booking if first clears 80%)	\$500–\$2K future	\$500–\$2K future + relationship	Tier B touring acts you want to grow with
Merch rights — 100% to comic, no cut	\$0	\$500–\$3,000/show	Always — never take a merch split
J Rodgers BBQ cross-promo (30-yr customer list)	\$0	\$1,000+ marketing reach	Local-pride pitches (Heath, Dusty)
Country radio trade (WKSJ, WDLT, Magic 99.9)	\$0	\$2,000–\$5,000 perceived ad value	Hi-volume promoters, country-leaning
Saraland/Mobile media (Lagniappe, AL.com)	\$0	\$1,000–\$3,000 PR value	First-of-series headliners
Same-night cash settlement (or NET-7 max)	\$0	High trust signal	Always offer; many venues are NET-30

C.3 · Three deal-structure templates — pick by tier

Template A · Flat guarantee (Tier C / first-time comics)

"\$1,500 flat for one show, \$2,500 flat for two shows. Includes hotel, ground, \$60 buyout per principal, BBQ dinner, comp tickets for crew + 4 guests. Deposit 50% on signing, balance same night cash."

Template B · Versus deal (Tier B workhorses — DEFAULT)

"\$5,000 versus 70% of net door over \$7,500 — whichever is greater. Net door = ticket revenue minus Square fees, comps, holds. F&B stays 100% with venue. Settlement same night cash or NET-7 wire."

Template C · Door split + low guarantee (Tier A anchors only)

"\$10,000 + 80% of net door above \$20,000. F&B stays 100% with venue. Settlement same night cash. Deposit 50% on signing, balance pre-show day."

C.4 · Counter-leverage scripts — when agents push back

AGENT SAYS	YOUR REPLY
"What's your guarantee?"	"Open to flat, versus, or door split. Send their standard quote and let's work backward from their draw on a 200-cap two-show."
"What's your draw history?"	"RG 158 has hosted [list 2-3 prior events]. Series launches July 2026 — debut headliner gets full marketing weight. \$800/show fixed Meta + 25K social reach + J Rodgers cross-promo + Mobile country radio trade."
Quote is too high	"Outside the budget for a debut series booking. Can we look at a versus deal — pays them more on a sellout but gives us breakeven protection?"
Wants full guarantee at top of range	"Guarantee at [-25% of ask] plus 70% net door above breakeven — that's where the upside is."
Asks for radius clause > 50 mi	"Standard 50 mi / 60 days is fine — anything beyond conflicts with our calendar."
Asks for all the door	Walk away. "Doesn't work — bar and F&B economics are how the venue stays in business."
Wants merch cut	Always offer 100% merch to comic. Never take a split.
Rider has a private chef line	Counter: "\$60/principal buyout instead of catered greenroom." Don't negotiate the menu.
Settlement timing pushed to NET-30	"Same night cash or NET-7. NET-30 doesn't work for our books."
"Need flight + hotel for entourage of 5"	"\$60 buyout × 5, hotel for principal + 1, ground for the group, additional rooms at our partner rate (comic covers cost)."
Asks for 2-show fee bump (+\$1K)	Pre-budget +30% on Tier B for 2-show; if you only want 1 show, say so up front.
Quote re-opens 90 days out	Hold them to the original written quote, or walk. This is bad-faith.

C.5 · Hard lines — never negotiate these away

- **Bar / F&B revenue** — 100% stays with venue. Always.
- **Radius clauses > 60 days / 50 miles** — kills your ability to book similar comics.
- **NET-30 settlement** — your cash flow can't carry that.
- **All-door / no-guarantee venue split** — kills bar economics.
- **Cancellation without notice** — must include 60-day-out = full refund + venue marketing reimbursement; 30-day-out = 50% deposit forfeit; 14-day-out = 100% deposit forfeit.
- **No-recording-any-form clause** — you need the right to capture the 60-second vertical clip.
- **100% advance payment demand** — 50% deposit on signing is the industry max for any comic under \$50K fee.

Appendix D · Pre-Flight Checklist (Veteran's Pass)

Lock these before sending email #1. Each unchecked box is a future loss event.

D.1 · Insurance

- ☐ Confirm general-liability carrier covers stand-up comedy (some policies have entertainment exclusions)
- ☐ **Per-show event cancellation insurance** — Event Helper, K&K, Hub International — \$150–\$250/show
- ☐ Liquor-liability rider current
- ☐ Certificate of Insurance template ready (agents request before quoting)

D.2 · Legal / contracts

- ☐ Booking-contract template via DocuSign (comedy-specific from Berger Goldstein, NathanTimmel.com, or industry standard)
- ☐ Cancellation language: 60 / 30 / 14-day-out tiers
- ☐ No-radius clauses > 60 days / 50 miles
- ☐ Same-night settlement clause OR NET-7 wire

D.3 · Operations

- ☐ **2-item-minimum POS workflow tested** — Square Terminal prompt + server training + door wristbands
- ☐ **Box-office process locked** — who scans tickets, tracks 2-item, handles will-call
- ☐ **Swing-comic on retainer** — 2 local Tier C, \$400 hold-fee + double-on-activation
- ☐ Greenroom prep checklist — water, towels, snacks, mirror, lock, coffee/tea

D.4 · Venue / hospitality

- ☐ Hampton Saraland (or partner) corporate rate signed in writing
- ☐ Ground transport vendors confirmed (party bus + Uber Business + limo backup)
- ☐ J Rodgers BBQ greenroom dinner SOP — same menu every time, \$50 cost target
- ☐ Hotel partner rate quoted in dollars, not negotiated per show

D.5 · Marketing / promotion

- ☐ Email-capture banner live on rg158ent.com homepage
- ☐ **NON-show email capture pipeline** — J Rodgers customer list import + festival waitlist + social contests (only way to hit 8K by Feb 2027)
- ☐ Meta Business Manager set up + first \$200 audience-research test running
- ☐ WKSJ Kicker 94.9, WDLT 98.3, Magic 99.9/105.5 radio rep contacts confirmed
- ☐ **TikTok content workflow** — who shoots, who edits, who uploads within 48hr

D.6 · Festival critical path (parallel — don't wait for comedy series to "succeed first")

- ☐ **Saraland city manager meeting THIS WEEK**
- ☐ Outdoor venue Plan A + Plan B scoped by end of June 2026
- ☐ **Wyatt Flores quote-lock email THIS WEEK** to Monaterra Music Group
- ☐ Parmalee CAA Nashville inquiry (Darin Murphy) — quote letter for April 2027 weekend headline 10K cap outdoor in Saraland AL
- ☐ Sponsorship deck drafted — 3 tiers (\$5K / \$25K / \$100K) for Bud Light, Ford, Trustmark, J Rodgers, Coors, Tito's, Wrangler, Cabela's, Sirius Highway

D.7 · Financial

- ☐ QBO sub-account "Festival 2027" opened — every comedy net dollar tracked here
- ☐ Square sub-location for ticketed shows separate from rental events
- ☐ Per-show P&L template locked — ticket rev, F&B rev, talent, agent commission (12%), production, insurance, marketing, hospitality, staff, fees, net
- ☐ **Snowball stress-test at 40% sellthrough** — does Show 2 still get funded? If no, lower Show 1 talent ceiling.

Appendix E · Realistic Forecast Range

Plan to the conservative case. Bank the realistic case. Celebrate the aspirational.

E.1 · Comedy series (8-month run, July 2026 → Feb 2027)

SCENARIO	AVG SELLTHROUGH	NET PER TICKETED NIGHT	8-MONTH TOTAL NET	FUNDS FESTIVAL?
Conservative (likely months 1–3)	40%	\$3,500	\$170K–\$220K	Partial — needs sponsorship to fill gap
Realistic (likely months 4–8)	60%	\$7,500	\$280K–\$350K	Yes — covers festival deposits + working capital
Aspirational (sellouts)	85%	\$12,500	\$420K–\$500K	Yes — overfunds festival, builds reserves

E.2 · Festival (April 2027, 2-day, 10K cap)

SCENARIO	TICKETS SOLD	NET
Conservative	6,500 (65%)	\$200K–\$350K
Realistic	8,500 (85%)	\$400K–\$550K
Aspirational (sellout)	10,000	\$580K–\$700K

Economics still work in conservative case because sponsorship + camping + F&B vendor cuts are independent of ticket sellthrough. Sponsorship is the most under-leveraged revenue line in the current plan — push it from \$100K projection to \$300K–\$500K target.

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